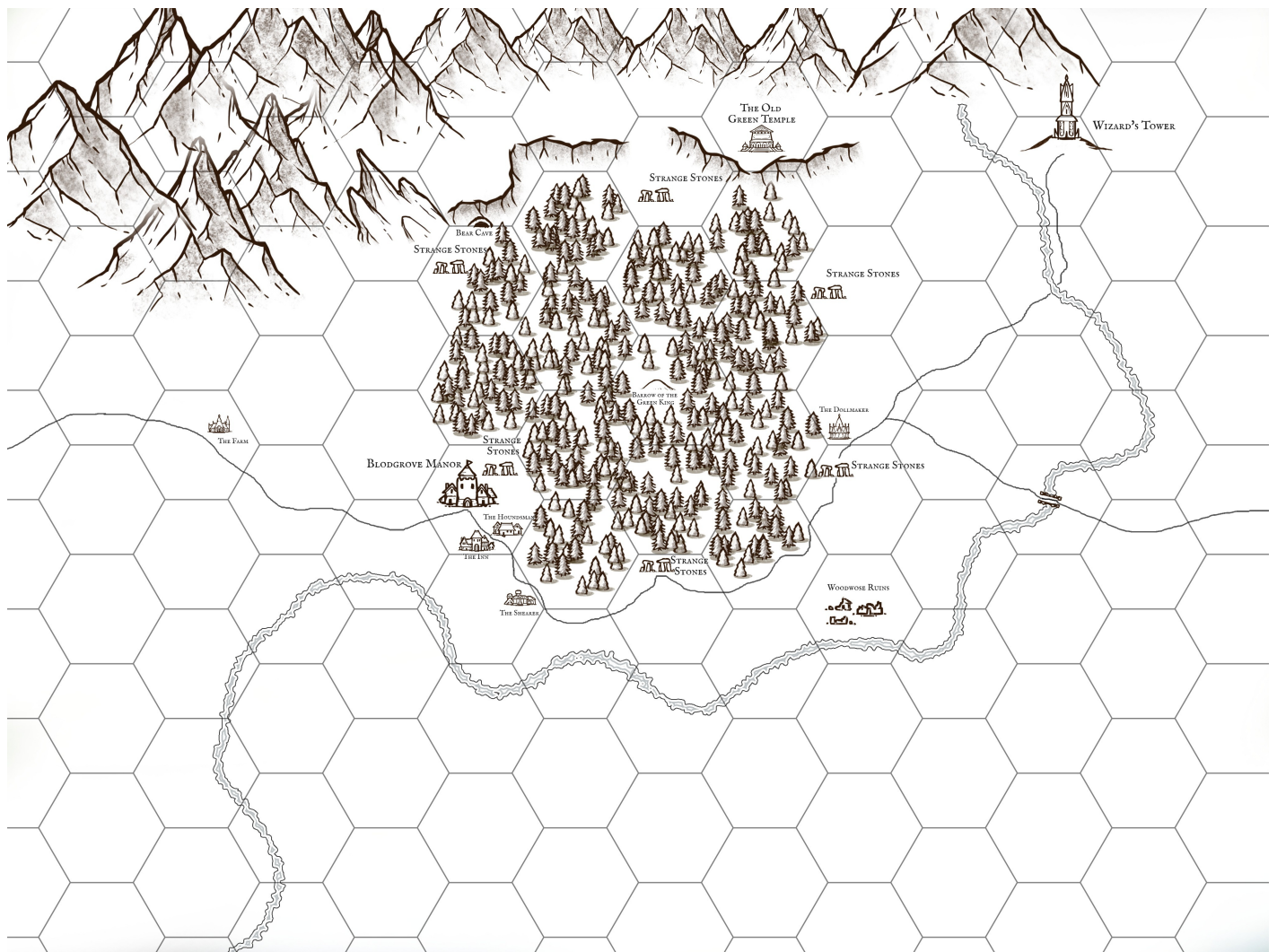


THE BEAST OF BLODGROVE



What's Actually Going On?

Lord Oswin Prym III is not who he says he is. His real name is Oitharan and he is an elf that was once a king of the Woodwose centuries ago. The Woodwose are a group of cannibalistic humans who lived in the North Sea Islands that would keep an elf as their king called a Green King. The Woodwose were driven out of the area centuries ago by the Airnish and Ceolish peoples. Oitharan hid in the forest after the fall of his kingdom as he is magically connected to the forest and will lose a large portion of his power should he leave. When the original Oswin Prym I, an Airnish human, was given these lands by the church, Oitharan attacked and killed him and took his identity becoming the new Oswin Prym I. Since elves have significantly longer lives than human, Ortherion, now known as Prym, would fake his own death and pretend to be his son, Oswin Prym II. He then did it again to become Oswin Prym III who he is now.

Over the years, Prym has been learning how to become a lich and then use his power to destroy the holy knights of the region and establish a new Green Kingdom. Prym has made a chamber under the forest which connects to the manor where you can find his phylactery. Prym has been slowly completing sacrifices which

require a lot of time and preparation to keep it secret. In recent years, some werewolves appeared in the area, so Prym has been more bold with completing his sacrifices as he has been dressing up as a werewolf using a bear pelt and is abducting people, takes them into the woods and then completes the sacrifices. Prym has to use the power from the sacrifices to dispel the locations around the wood called the "strange stones" which work as wards to contain whatever power is in the woods. Once those stones are dispelled, Prym will then attempt to sacrifice his wife as the final sacrifice needed to power his phylactery and then will kill himself using a potion and rise again as a lich.

There is a wizard named Rhyndon Everbright in the area who moved here 3-4 years ago researching the weird powers detected in the area. He found evidence that Prym was attempting to become a lich and attempted to confront him. However, Prym anticipated this, and with the help of some local bandits, attacked and captured Rhyndon and is keeping him captive in his dungeon to draw power from him.

Recently, Prym told his wife, Lady Faeleth Prym, what his plan was, arrogantly assuming she would be supportive but she was horrified. She pretended to be supportive but then tried to write a letter to her sister, Ruma. She yelled for her favorite squire, Garen, frantically telling him she needed him to deliver a letter. She was only able to write one line when Prym approached her. Lady Prym crumpled the letter to hide it, but Prym found it. Knowing Garen was on his way up and didn't want to make him suspicious, Prym put Lady Prym under a charm spell, then put his seal on the letter and had Lady Prym hand it to Garen who then took it to Lady Ruma.

Adventure Hooks:

Lady Ruma of the Temple asks for the adventurers' help

"My husband is sick. I need your help"

Lady Ruma of the Temple received this letter from a young squire (Garen) who travelled through the night to deliver it. It was from her sister, Lady Faeleth Prym. The squire said that Lady Prym has frantically called down for him to come and deliver the letter as fast as he could. But, when he went upstairs and got the letter from her, she seemed calm standing alongside her husband, Lord Prym, and gently handed the note to him. Still, he came as quickly as her initial urgency demanded.

Lady Ruma has sent multiple priests to Blodgrove to check on the situation, but they have all been turned away except one, which hasn't returned. The ones that have returned have learned that the area has been experiencing regular werewolf attacks.

Lady Ruma reached out to you to ask you if you can check on the situation and offers ownership of a small homestead not too far outside the city to compensate should Lady Prym be proven to be safe. Garen the squire will offer to take the party back to Blodgrove.

Alternatively, the adventurers may be called to investigate the werewolf attacks by the Radiant Dawn or the other members of the Brynnrhosyn Pact

The Letter:

- The letter was folded and put into an envelope with the Lord's seal to be delivered (Upon inspection, it's apparent that the letter had been crumpled up prior to being folded and put in the envelope. Garen does not know why this is the case)
- The writing on the letter starts at the top of the page and stops without punctuation (This shows that Lady Prym meant to write a longer message but was stopped)
- (What really happened: Lady Prym called for the squire to deliver her letter and she began writing it. Lord

Prym caught her and she crumpled up the paper. He put her under a charm spell and then found the paper, read it, and when the squire arrived, pretended like he was also having him deliver the letter and applied his seal to the envelope)

While traveling to Blodgrove, the party may encounter the following rumors:

- There have been werewolves in the area and recently, there have been vicious attacks in the woods on full moons
- Oswin Prym IV might soon be returning from training in an Outland Kingdom
 - *Oswin Prym IV is not real and a rumor started by Lord Prym so he can later take his place and pretend that Oswin Prym III dies*
- If the wolves don't get you, the Woodwose might
 - *There's actually no more Woodwose in this area*
- The old Green Temple has recently been occupied by some knight from the south and his men
 - *This knight and his men are the werewolves in the area. They are actually trying to help this child that begged for Lycanthropy to be cured of an illness. This group is dedicated to serving Selune and protecting those outcast by the Radiant Dawn*
- Father Mouric will be retiring soon
 - *He has told people many times that he will be stepping down, but Lord Prym always convinces him to stay*
 - *Most recently, a young cleric that Lady Ruma had sent to investigate was being considered by Father Mouric for the role but that cleric ended up as a victim of Lord Prym's sacrifice*
- The Wizard that used to live in the area has been gone for almost a year now
- The Woodwose ruins are haunted
 - *The ruins are occupied by bandits...mostly.*

Blodgrove Locations

- The Manor
- The Strange Stones
- The Inn
- The Farm
- The Sheep Farm - Makes special Blodgrove Blackwool Clothing
- The Old Green Temple
- The Bear Cave
 - Skeleton of a bear found here with many of the bones now missing
 - A coat button with the Prym crest can be found here
 - At the back of the cave, there is an opening which leads to an underground ravine - Need to make an encounter table
 - Connects to Prym's Dungeon
- The Wizard's Tower
- Woodwose town ruins - common bandit hideout
- The Blodgrove Forest
 - Thick woods, lots of small animals
 - Mostly pine trees
- The Houndsman's Kennel
 - Owns several dogs - several have come up missing while searching for victims - Dog's names: Scout, Dart, Leaper, Red,
 - Several dogs have been leading them to a cave near the woods or to the manor
 - Fully believes the Woodwose are still around and that they are the ones killing, not the werewolves

Character List:

Lord Oswin Prym III

Lady Faeleth Prym

Lady Ruma of the Light

The Houndsman - Provides dogs to help with tracking but the dogs keep leading them back home

Garen the Squire

The Innkeeper and her husband

The Shearer

The Farmer

The Dollmaker

The Wizard

Rangers of the Brynnrhosyn Pact / Werewolves

Sir Osh Wellis

Sir Malon Weyfid

Essex of Alaron

Collan of Oreigh

Everen

Character Details:

Lady Faeleth Prym

- Very calm and insists that she no longer needs help
 - *Is actually under a charm spell which can be broken but will be recast immediately if in the presence of the lord - which he will make it hard to not be*
- *Lord Prym tried to tell Lady Prym of his plan to be a lich, but she found it repulsive. She pretended to go along with it then snuck away and tried to write the letter but was caught*

Lord Oswin Prym III

- Claims to be an Airnish human who fought in wars against the old Woodwose kingdoms in the north
 - *He is actually a very old elf named Oitharan who was once a Green King - which is an elf which led a kingdom of the Woodwose men*
 - *He began the ruse as he killed the original Oswin Prym I and took his identity to become lord of this valley. To keep up the charade, he pretended to die when he became old enough that a human would, and then pretended to be Oswin Prym II and now Oswin Prym III*
- Says he has a son, Oswin Prym IV, who is abroad and is hopefully coming back soon
 - *He doesn't have a son and is planning to have Oswin Prym III "die" and then appear as Oswin Prym IV as he had done previously*
- He says he is sick with a flu like illness
 - *If you spy on him, you can find evidence that he is lying*
- Does not attend any religious service and is known to do that in private
 - *Doesn't actually ever do religious services and pressures Father Mouric to say that he provides private services*
- He has a weird scar on the top of his ears (This can be perceived with a high perception check)
 - *If asked about it, he says they are battle scars from fighting in the Woodwose wars in the north*
 - *They are actually the result of mutilating his ears to appear human*
- *He captures people antagonistic to the wood and to the old faith and sacrifices them to the old God to become a lich and gain power*
- **He knows of the werewolf pack is in the area and he is trying to frame them for the murders so that knights of the Radiant Dawn might respond to the area. He will then try to sacrifice the holy warriors to the old god and use the power gained to reign over the region*
- *On the nights prior to the sacrifices, he pretends to be Father Mouric and prepared the strange stones*

ritual sites. He wears Father Mouric's iconic large black hat but also wears a black cloak over his cassock and hides his face behind a high collar

- *Prym has to place 5 amber blades in the ritual sites around the sacrifice location which will be used in the later ritual to turn him into a lich*
- There is a painting found in the manor of Oswin Prym I that looks exactly like Oswin Prym III
- Claims to know nothing about the wizard if asked
 - *He actually has the Wizard locked up in his dungeon*

Father Mouric

- Very old priest of the Radiant Dawn Temple
- Is senile and very suggestable - he believes anything he is told has happened within reason
- His attendants will say that he always goes to bed as early as 5 PM
- He wants to retire but keeps getting pressure by Lord Prym to stay

The Wizard - Ryndon Everbright?

- Locked in Prym's dungeon for investigating him and finding out the Lord's plans

Rangers of the Brynrhosyn Pact - (The Werewolves)

Sir Osh Wellis, Sir Malon Weyfid, Esser of Alaron, Collan of Oreigh, Everen

- Everen is a teen that was near death and sought help from them after being thrown out by father mouric for not being Airnish - Party might encounter him and be attacked briefly until his pack stops him and takes him back to their temple base
- Everen is brown and blonde as a wolf and doesn't have any fur that matches what is found at the scene

Characters' Goals:

Lady Ruma would like to know the Lady Prym is safe.

Lady Prym would like to escape

Lord Prym wants to become a lich, blame the werewolves in the area, and kill the holy knights that will respond to the werewolf attacks.

Werewolf knight is trying to train Everon to control his wolf form and also to protect the innocent of the area which is the stated goal of the Rangers of the Brynrhosyn Pact

Rhyndon Everbright would like to be freed and stop Prym

The Shearer doesn't trust Prym

The Dollmaker is a Halfling who thinks that the werewolves are responsible for the attacks but that we should try to reason with them

The Houndsman thinks that the Woodwose are still in the area and causing the attacks - also fully supports Prym

The Farmer would like to get a lower tax rate for shipping grain - believes the attacks are caused by werewolves

Wolf Attacks

- Bodies are found with their hearts and large portions of their chest eaten and scratches
 - *High perception or animal handling will see that the scratches don't appear to be as deep as you might expect from a werewolf*
- Black fur is found at the scene
 - *If tracked using a hound or some ability, it would be found that this fur tracks back to a bear cave where a bear skeleton can be found*
- If asked, animals nearby would say they saw a large black hairy thing attack the victim
- All attacks happen during full moons, but not every full moon.

- *If Lord Pym is pressed for time in some way, the attacks will begin happening on other nights*